

On thematic blends

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Two-movers which display combination of two or more modern themes are aplenty but seldom a modern theme finds company of a classical theme in this genre. When a white piece interferes with a black line piece either actively or passively it contributes to 'Arguelles theme'. In the problem below for study white knight interferes with black queen in the tries to set up diagonal threats by white but these fail as the shut off black queen moves the other way to defeat the threats. These defences which refute the threatened mates after tries actually appear as defences and the same threats reappear as mates-the paradoxical 'Dombrovskis theme'

E. Salazar

I prize, The Problemist 1980



Mate in two moves

Try 1.Nc2? (2.Qxa2) A) 1...aN any 2.Nb4 !But 1...Qg4! (a)
Try 1.Ne2? (2.Bf3 (B) but 1...Qa4!!(b)
Key 1.Nxb7! (2.Qd8/Qg4 (a)/Qa4 (b) 2.Qxa2 (A)/Bf3 (B)

The long range threats and fine defences together with economical construction make this a splendid problem-a combine of two themes-a modern and a classical. In Arguelles here it is white which interferes with black queen.

In the second twoer below the Russian trio shows a synthesis of

Hannelius and Dombrovskis in three phase zagoruyko with changed mates. This is excellent construction.

Pavel Murashev, Anatoly Siesarenko and Alexander Feoktistov
I place, 9th WCCT 2012-13



Mate in two moves

Try 1.Qb6? (2.d3 A) 1...fxe3 2.Qxe3 1...Rd4 2.Qxd4 but 1...Nxd5! a
Try 1.Ng4? 2.d3 A
1...Nxd5 2.Qb1; 1...Rd4 2.Rxd4 but 1...fxe3 a; 1.Qb7? 2.Bf5 B
1...Nxd5 2.Qxd5 but 1...fxe3 a
Try 1.Qg8? (2.Bf5 B) 1...fxe3 2.Qg4 but 1...Nxd5! B
1.d7! (2.Qxf4) 1...fxe3 2.d3 A
1...Nxd5 2.Bf5 B 1...Ne2 2.Qb1 1...Rd4 2.Rxd4

Problem for solving given below combines Le Grand, Barnes and Rudenko themes

A Siesarenko

3 pr, FIDE World Cup 2015



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'White batteries': **Key 1.Ne6!**

Readers may send in their queries to
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